

Winter habitat

In winter, migrating snowy owls reach the southernmost parts of their range, where they may hunt ducks and grebes on marshes or moorland, or even rely on carrion.

Finding food

Snowy owls regularly move from place to place according to the supply of food. They stay in the same location only if prey is abundant.

Arctic owl

The snowy owl survives and even breeds within the Arctic Circle in Canada, Greenland, and Russia, where it hunts burrowing rodents, such as lemmings and voles. Only during the bitter, dark Arctic winter does it move further south.

Snowy owls have excellent eyesight, like all birds of prey.

Barred plumage

All snowy owls have small, black, bar-like markings. These are more extensive in the larger female—especially on the sides and back.

KEY

- Snowy owl breeding range
- Snowy owl nonbreeding range

Silent wings

As in other owls, the feathers in the wings of a snowy owl have comblike fringes, which help muffle the sound as the wing flaps through the air.

A SNOWY OWL'S WINGSPAN MAY BE MORE THAN

5 FT
(1.5 M)

